Universal Human Values — II · 21LEM202T

Unit 1 · Session 9 · SLO 1 — Solved Worksheet

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Unit – 1 : Session – 9 | Analysing Desires, Thoughts and Expectations

Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

• Q1. Three categorisations of desires/thoughts/expectations: (1) By SOURCE of motivation — arising from PRECONDITIONING, from SENSATION, or from NATURAL ACCEPTANCE. (2) By NATURE of the need — needs of the SELF (happiness, respect, understanding) versus needs of the BODY (food, shelter). (3) By TIME — CONTINUOUS (always wanted, e.g., respect) versus TEMPORARY (occasional, e.g., eating). These three lenses together reveal what the desire really is and whether it can be fulfilled materially.

• Q2. Need of the Self (I): happiness, respect, trust, knowledge — CONTINUOUS in time, QUALITATIVE (not measurable in quantity), fulfilled by RIGHT UNDERSTANDING and RIGHT FEELING. Need of the Body: food, clothing, shelter — TEMPORARY in time, QUANTITATIVE (limited — one can eat only so much), fulfilled by PHYSICAL FACILITY. CONCLUSION of the exercise: most of our significant desires are needs of the Self, yet most of our effort and resources go into physical facility for the body — a fundamental misplacement of effort that explains why prosperity without happiness is common.

• Q3. PRECONDITIONING: motivation from assumptions absorbed from society/upbringing without verification ('more money = more respect') — makes conduct INDEFINITE and leads to ENSLAVEMENT by prevailing trends. SENSATION: motivation from bodily tastes and excitements — temporary, addictive, also leads to ENSLAVEMENT (of the body/senses). NATURAL ACCEPTANCE: motivation from the Self's own verified inner acceptance — constant, self-evident, leads to SELF-ORGANISATION (swatantrata) and definite conduct. Only the third makes a person self-organised; the first two make one partantra (dependent/enslaved).